



When I look at the Nothing Phone 4a, at first glance, it doesn't look different from the phone that came before it. The company's signature transparent design is still here and if you place it next to last year's Nothing Phone 3a, you can see the resemblance. But this time the shift isn't about the design, it's about the price. Nothing Phone 4a starts at Rs 31,999, and it now sits in a much more competitive part of the smartphone market. At this price segment, the selling point should not be design alone. Buyers expect strong performance, versatile cameras, a good display, and battery life that can easily last through a full day.

The main challenge for the Nothing Phone 4a is that it isn't competing with last year's Nothing Phone 3a. It's competing with every strong contender around the Rs 30,000 price point. So, I chose the most obvious alternative, the OnePlus Nord 5.

Design

Design has always been one of Nothing's biggest strengths, and the Phone 4a continues that legacy. The transparent back panel still gives the phone a distinctive look. That actually is a head turner, and a lot of people have also asked me in public, 'Which phone are you using?'

Of course, design is subjective; some will love it because it looks different

from the others, while others might prefer something more understated.

The new Glyph Bar is the biggest visual change this year. Instead of the full Glyph lights used in previous models, the Phone 4a now uses a rectangular strip made up of 63 mini LEDs arranged in 7 segments. The Glyph Bar can be customised as well through the settings menu, and it even reacts to the system if the user adjusts the volume. There is one small but satisfying detail: the small red square on the Glyph Bar, which lights up when you start recording video.

In daily use, the glossy finish on the transparent back does smudge. But Nothing is giving a transparent case in the box for the first time to address this.